The Means of Accomplishment of the Vase

Kalaśasādhana-nāma · Toh 2878 · Derge Tengyur
བུམ་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས་ཞེས་བྱ།

The Means of Accomplishment of the Vase, known in Sanskrit as the Kalaśasādhana and in Tibetan as Bum pa'i sgrub thabs, is a brief ritual manual centered on the wrathful deity Vajrapāṇi, to whom it opens with homage as the king of wrathful ones and the holder of the indestructible. In verse, it sets out the practice of the vase. The practitioner arranges ritual substances on a blue maṇḍala and generates themselves as the chosen deity. The vase is visualized as a palace of wisdom, and the five medicines, grains, essences, jewels, and scented waters placed within it are blessed into an ocean of nectar. The text then describes binding the practitioner and their seat with a thread spun by a maiden as part of the protective rite. This work is Toh 2878 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the large class of tantric sādhanas, or practice texts, composed by Indian masters and preserved in Tibetan translation.

In the language of India: kalaśasādhanaṃmāma. In the language of Tibet: The Means of Accomplishment of the Vase.

Homage to glorious Vajrapāṇi.

Bowing deeply with the crown of my head
To the king of wrathful ones, the holder of the indestructible, who became the enemy of the vicious,
For the sake of benefiting myself and others
I shall set down the practice of the vase.

Upon a blue maṇḍala,
Having arranged the substances,
Generate yourself as the chosen deity.
In the vase, as the palace of wisdom,
The five medicines, the five grains, the five essences,
The five jewels and the five scented waters
Are blessed into an ocean of nectar,
And generated as the deity according to the rite.

Then, together with the practitioner's seat and bed,
With a thread spun by a maiden
Bind yourself and the deity together.

Sending forth is the nature of speech;
Gathering back is a limb of the mantra.
If you grow weary, hold the dhāraṇī cord.
By relying on the two paths, upper and lower,
Signs will arise.
If they do not, perform the fire offering for the activity;
That brings forth the result.

This is the practice of the vase,
The entrance to the door of recitation that relies on the path.
Empowerment, ablution and the like,
Whatever is done, will bring accomplishment.
May those who are worthy vessels understand its meaning
And attain the common and supreme accomplishments.

The Means of Accomplishment of the Vase, composed by the master Suvāgīśvarakīrti, is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "Five scented waters" renders □□□□□□□□□. In tantric rites □□□□□□ can mean urine, but here it stands in the standard list of vase substances: five jewels, medicines, grains, essences and scents. The sense of scented water therefore seems intended.

The "two paths, upper and lower" and the "sending forth" and "gathering back" during recitation are stated tersely. They probably refer to the emanation and reabsorption of mantra light through the connecting thread between practitioner and vase.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.